

5-Players Landlord

A climbing game with hidden partnership, occasional solo play, doubling and bombs

Setup

Play with **5 players** and **108 cards** using two full decks including jokers. Deal **21 cards** to each player and leave a **3-card kitty**.

Rank order: Red Joker > Black Joker > 2 > A > K > Q > J > 10 > 9 > 8 > 7 > 6 > 5 > 4 > 3.

Landlords

Before dealing, reveal one random card, then shuffle it back into the draw pile.

The player dealt that card becomes the **Public Landlord** and takes the kitty. The player holding the other copy of that card is the **Hidden Landlord**. Both landlords play together against the **3 Peasants**.

If the Public Landlord holds both copies of the landlord card, they play **solo** against all 4 other players.

The Hidden Landlord stays secret until their landlord card is played, unless the partnership is revealed before play.

Stake / Doubling

Before play, either landlord may choose to reveal the partnership. If so, the Hidden Landlord identifies themselves, the multiplier doubles, and the landlords may show hands to each other.

If neither landlord reveals before play, the Hidden Landlord stays secret until their landlord card is played. Once the Hidden Landlord's identity is confirmed, the landlords may show hands to each other.

After this reveal/pass step, all players simultaneously decide whether to double. Each player may double at most once. Then the Public Landlord leads the first play.

Bombs of **5 of a kind or stronger** also double the multiplier. Track the final multiplier as m .

Example: partnership reveal $\times 2$, one player doubles $\times 2$, one strong bomb $\times 2$ gives $m = 8$.

Variant: Play 5 rounds so that each player is Public Landlord once. The Public Landlord takes the kitty and calls one card to determine the Hidden Landlord. The player holding the called card becomes the Hidden Landlord; if the Public Landlord holds it, they play solo.

Playing

The **Public Landlord leads first**. On your turn, either beat the previous play or pass.

To beat a play, use the **same combination type and**

a higher rank, or play a bomb. Bombs beat normal combinations.

The round ends immediately when one player has no cards left. That player's whole team wins.

Combinations

Combination	Requirement
Single	1 card
Pair	2 equal ranks
Triple	3 equal ranks
Full House	Triple + pair
Single Run	5+ consecutive singles
Pair Run	3+ consecutive pairs
Triple Run	2+ consecutive triples
Full House Run	2+ consecutive triples, each with a pair

No 2s or Jokers in runs. For Triple and Full House Runs, compare by the rank of the triples.

Examples: 6-7-8-9-10; 7-7, 8-8, 9-9.

Bombs

Bombs beat normal combinations. Stronger bombs beat weaker bombs. Bombs of the same size are compared by card rank.

Order	Bomb
1	Quad
2	2 Jokers, same colour
3	5 of a kind
4	6 of a kind
5	3 Jokers, any kind
6	7 of a kind
7	8 of a kind
8	4 Jokers

Only bombs of **5 of a kind or stronger** double the multiplier.

Scoring

First determine the final multiplier m , then use the payout table.

Result	Payout
Landlords win	each landlord $+15m$; each peasant $-10m$
Peasants win	each peasant $+10m$; each landlord $-15m$
Solo wins	solo $+40m$; each other player $-10m$
Solo loses	solo $-40m$; each other player $+10m$